FALBATECH

DIAL FT

User Guide · DFTv1.5



A smart dial with a round touchscreen
for creative work, editing and everyday tasks.

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Contents

1. Getting started
2. Controls
3. HOME screen
4. Profiles
5. DaVinci Resolve: COLOR
6. Smart Touch Ring and Smart Scroll
7. Pomodoro, Timer, Stopwatch and clock
8. RGB ring
9. Settings
10. Configurator and custom profiles
11. Firmware update
12. DIAL FT Helper (optional)
13. Troubleshooting
14. Specifications and safety

1. Getting started

1. Connect DIAL FT to your computer (macOS, Windows or Linux) with the USB-C cable. No drivers are needed.
2. After the FalbaTech logo a short tutorial appears: turn, click, hold, swipe and tap, one after another.
3. Open **Settings** → **Host OS** and choose your system (macOS or Windows). It decides whether shortcuts use Cmd or Ctrl.
4. Pick an app on the HOME screen by turning the dial and open it with a click or a tap.

> Every profile works right away, with no software on your computer. To the computer DIAL FT is a USB keyboard and mouse. The optional DIAL FT Helper adds Spotify cover art, automatic profile switching and the clock.



DIAL FT from above: HOME screen, dial and RGB ring. Turning the dial selects an app.

2. Controls

Turn	select an icon / profile action (e.g. volume, frame) / select a row in settings
Click	opens an app; in a profile switches the mode (e.g. FRAME → ZOOM); in settings changes the value
Hold	back to the first HOME page (Pomodoro and the profile keep running)
Swipe	left / right: change HOME page; in a profile swipe right: back to HOME; Settings → RGB → Touch ring
Tap	opens an icon; in a profile the tap action (e.g. mute, play); on-screen buttons (LIKE, CAM, RESET)
Screen rim	Smart Touch Ring: slide your finger around the edge like a ring - fine control

The screen dims after 45 s of inactivity (or shows the clock). The first turn, click or touch only wakes it.

3. HOME screen

Icons are arranged in pages. The dots at the bottom show the current page. Turning walks through all icons on all pages.

EVERYDAY	Pomodoro, Smart Scroll, Volume, Media, Spotify, Meetings
CREATIVE	DaVinci, Premiere, Final Cut, Photoshop, Lightroom, Pixelmator
DESIGN	Figma, Blender, Fusion 360, KiCad, MIDI, herdr
SYSTEM	System, Settings, Timer, Stopwatch, Claude, Codex
CUSTOM / CUSTOM 2	your profiles from the configurator (up to 12)

This is the factory layout. In the configurator (chapter 10) you can arrange the desktops your way: up to 6 desktops with 6 icons each, your own names and order; hide apps you do not use in the Hidden section. A dot next to an icon marks the active profile.

4. Profiles

In a profile a click changes the mode (the dots under the name show which). Turning performs the mode action, tapping the center performs the tap action. `Mod` = Ctrl on Windows, Cmd on macOS (Settings → Host OS).

Profile	Mode	Turn
Volume	VOLUME	system volume
	tap	mute
Smart Scroll	VERTICAL	scroll up / down
	HORIZONTAL	scroll left / right
	tap	invert direction
Media	VOLUME	volume
	TRACK	previous / next track
	tap	play / pause
Spotify	VOLUME	volume
	TRACK	previous / next track
	SEEK	seek in track (`Shift` + `←/→`)
	tap	play / pause; LIKE button = like song (`Alt` + `Shift` + `B`)
Meetings	ZOOM / TEAMS / MEET	volume; the mode selects the app
	tap	microphone on/off (red ring = muted); CAM button = camera

DaVinci Resolve	FRAME	frame step (`←/→`)
	ZOOM	timeline zoom (`Mod` + `=/−`)
	SCROLL	timeline scroll
	JKL	`J` / `L`
	COLOR	point the mouse at a value on the Color page and turn
	tap	play / pause (`Space`); screen rim = frame jog
Premiere Pro	FRAME	frame step
	ZOOM	timeline zoom (`=` / `−`)
	EDIT	previous / next edit point
	JKL	`J` / `L`
	tap	play / pause; rim = jog
Final Cut Pro	FRAME	frame step
	ZOOM	zoom (`Cmd` + `=/−`)
	EDIT	previous / next edit point
	JKL	`J` / `L`
	tap	play / pause; rim = jog
Photoshop	BRUSH	brush size (`[` / `]`)
	HARDNESS	brush hardness
	ZOOM	zoom
	HISTORY	undo / redo
	LAYER	layer down / up
	tap	fit on screen (`Mod` + `0`)
Lightroom Classic	ADJUST	selected slider - / + (fast turn = big steps)
	SLIDER	previous / next slider (`,` / `.`)
	PHOTO	previous / next photo
	ZOOM	zoom
	tap	before / after (`\`)

Pixelmator Pro	BRUSH	brush size
	HARDNESS	softer / harder
	OPACITY	opacity 10-100%
	ZOOM	zoom
	HISTORY	undo / redo
	LAYER	previous / next layer
	tap	zoom to fit (`Cmd` + `0`)
Figma	ZOOM	zoom
	OPACITY	layer opacity 10-100%
	LAYER	previous / next layer (`Shift` + `Tab` / `Tab`)
	HISTORY	undo / redo
	tap	zoom to fit (`Shift` + `1`)
Blender	ZOOM	view zoom
	ORBIT	orbit left / right
	TILT	orbit up / down
	FRAME	frame
	HISTORY	undo / redo
	tap	view all (`Home`); mouse over the 3D view
Fusion 360	ZOOM	zoom
	ORBIT	orbit (like Shift + middle mouse)
	PAN	pan (like middle mouse)
	HISTORY	undo / redo
	tap	fit (`F6`); mouse over the viewport
KiCad	ZOOM	zoom
	PAN X	pan left / right
	PAN Y	pan up / down
	LAYER	layer + / `-`
	ROTATE	rotate item (`R` / `Shift` + `R`)
	tap	`Esc`
MIDI	CC	turn = dial CC (0–127 or relative), ring = second CC
	tap	dial click = note or CC 0/127; tap = MIDI settings

System	APPS	switch apps
	DESKTOP	previous / next desktop
	BRIGHTNESS	screen brightness*
	UNDO	undo / redo
	tap	Mission Control / Task View

* Brightness keys work where the system supports them (usually a built-in laptop display). Final Cut Pro and Pixelmator Pro are macOS only. In Blender and Fusion 360 keep the mouse over the 3D view.

Spotify

Tracks, volume and play/pause use media keys and work even with Spotify in the background. SEEK and LIKE need the Spotify window in front. With DIAL FT Helper the screen shows cover art, title, artist and track progress.

MIDI

DIAL FT is also a USB MIDI device called “DIAL FT” - no drivers, in any music app (Ableton, Logic, FL Studio, Bitwig) and e.g. Fairlight. In the MIDI profile turning sends the dial CC, the touch ring a second CC and a click a note (or CC 0/127). A tap opens the settings: CC numbers, channel 1–16, absolute (0–127) or relative mode (best for DAWs), note and sensitivity. Use MIDI learn in your app. When the app sends values back, the DIAL screen shows the current state. Macros also have “MIDI CC” and “MIDI note” steps.

Claude (Claude Code)

The Claude app controls **Claude Code** in the terminal - on macOS, Windows and Linux, with the official Claude Code shortcuts. **Turn** - arrows ↑/↓ (choose an option in a permission prompt, command history). **Click** - Enter (confirm). **Tap the screen** - Esc (interrupt Claude; work done so far is kept). **MODE** button - Shift+Tab (work mode: default / accept edits / plan).

Notifications (with DIAL FT Helper): when Claude Code waits for your permission or answer, DIAL opens the Claude screen by itself, the ring pulses orange and HOME shows “CLAUDE NEEDS YOU”. When Claude is done - a green flash. The computer plays a sound and shows a notification. While Claude works, a “WORKING” ring spins on screen. With the Helper DIAL opens the Claude screen when you switch to the Claude app, and the Codex screen when you switch to the ChatGPT / Codex app. The Helper installer asks whether to add the notifications to the Claude Code settings (hooks); you can also do it later - see chapter 12.

Codex (OpenAI)

The Codex app works the same way for **Codex CLI** (OpenAI) in the terminal: turn ↑/↓, click Enter, tap Esc and the same notifications (working / needs you / done). Codex has no mode shortcut, so there is no MODE button. Notifications use Codex hooks (~/.codex/hooks.json) - the Helper installer asks about them when it finds Codex. After adding them type `/hooks` in Codex and approve them: Codex runs only hooks the user has approved.

herdr

herdr is a terminal multiplexer for many AI agents at once (e.g. several Claude Code sessions in several projects). With DIAL FT Helper (macOS, Linux) the herdr screen shows how many agents are **waiting** for you, how many are **working** and how many are **done**. When one waits, the ring pulses orange, HOME shows “AGENT WAITING” and the computer plays a sound. **Turn** - next / previous herdr tab, **click** - Enter, **tap** - Esc, **WAITING** button - jump to the agent that waits. The shortcuts assume the default herdr prefix Ctrl+B. Nothing to configure - the Helper finds a running herdr by itself.

Meetings

Click to choose the app: ZOOM, TEAMS or MEET (Google Meet in a browser). Tap mutes the microphone - the RGB ring then pulses red. The CAM button toggles the camera. DIAL keeps track of the state itself; if you mute with the mouse, tap twice to get back in sync.

5. DaVinci Resolve: COLOR

The COLOR mode in the DaVinci profile controls the real controls on the Color page - no software needed, also in the free DaVinci Resolve.

1. In the DaVinci profile click until **HOVER + TURN** appears.
2. Point the mouse at a value, e.g. Temp, Tint, Contrast, Saturation or the ribbed bar under the Lift / Gamma / Gain / Offset wheel.
3. Turn the dial. A tap changes the step: FINE / NORMAL / COARSE. The screen rim gives the smallest steps.

> Turning works like dragging with the mouse. Keep the pointer over a value - over another item (e.g. a node) it would move it.

6. Smart Touch Ring and Smart Scroll

Smart Touch Ring: slide your finger around the screen edge. It works like a second, finer dial. Settings per profile: **Settings** → **Touch ring** (or swipe left from the RGB ring screen).

Touch mode	SMOOTH or STEP
Sensitivity	LOW / MEDIUM / HIGH
Inertia	momentum after a flick: OFF / LOW / MEDIUM / HIGH
Direction	NORMAL / REVERSE
Adaptive	faster movement = bigger changes
Touch ring	on / off for this profile

Smart Scroll: scrolling with acceleration (SMART) or constant (PRECISION), momentum and vertical / horizontal axis (click). Reversing the direction stops the momentum immediately; so does touching the screen.

7. Pomodoro, Timer, Stopwatch and clock

Pomodoro: turn to set the focus time (when stopped), click or tap to start / pause, RESET to start over. Set the break in Settings → Pomo break. When a period ends the screen blinks and the ring flashes white. The timer keeps running while you use other profiles.

Timer (hourglass icon): turn to set 5 s to 99 min (5 s steps below a minute), click or tap to start / pause, RESET to start over; while paused turning adds or removes 30 s. At the end “TIME'S UP”: the screen and ring blink for half a minute, a click dismisses. The timer runs in the background - HOME shows the remaining time instead of the desktop name.

Stopwatch: click or tap to start / stop, LAP records a lap, RESET (when stopped) clears it. Shows tenths of a second and the last two laps.

Sound on the computer: with DIAL FT Helper the end of Pomodoro, the Timer and the stand-up reminder also play a sound and show a notification on the computer. Turn it off in the configurator.

Statistics: sessions today and in the last 7 days (when DIAL knows the time - see below).

Stand-up reminder: after 50 minutes of work without a 5-minute break DIAL shows “TIME TO STAND UP”. Any input dismisses it. Turn it off in Settings → Stand-up.

Clock face: when idle DIAL shows the time, date, seconds ring, Pomodoro and the song title. DIAL has no battery clock - the time is set by the configurator (when connected) or by DIAL FT Helper (permanently). Without it the screen simply dims.

8. RGB ring

Mode	Off, Follow (light follows the dial), Ambient, Breathe, Rainbow
Color	theme color, 36 hues or white - remembered separately for each theme
Brightness	20-100%
Pomodoro	the ring shows Pomodoro progress
Action flash	short flash on actions
Idle off	turns off with the screen
Direction	light direction relative to the dial

A red pulse means the microphone is muted in the Meetings profile.

9. Settings

Theme	color theme: Ocean, Amber, Mint, Violet, Rose, Mono, Color (every app in its own color), FalbaTech
Host OS	Windows (Ctrl shortcuts) or macOS (Cmd shortcuts) - set it to match your computer
Scroll dir	scroll direction
Brightness	DIAL screen brightness
RGB ring	quick RGB ring on / off
Pomo break	Pomodoro break: 3 / 5 / 10 / 15 min
Touch jog ... Jog dir	DaVinci rim jog: on/off, speed, inertia, direction
Touch ring >	Smart Touch Ring - per-profile settings (see below)
Auto profile	automatic profile switching with DIAL FT Helper
Clock face	clock face when idle
Stand-up	stand-up reminder after 50 min of work
Tutorial >	runs the tutorial again
Version	firmware version

Changes are saved automatically in DIAL.

10. Configurator and custom profiles

The configurator is the page **falbatech.click/dial-ft**. It works in Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge on a computer - nothing to install. Everything is saved in DIAL, so it then works on any computer.

1. Plug in DIAL FT and click **Connect DIAL FT**. Choose DIAL FT in the window.
2. **General**: theme, system, brightness, RGB ring, Pomodoro, auto profile, clock, reminder.
3. **Home screen - desktops**: drag icons between desktops (or click an icon, then where it should go), rename and reorder desktops, move apps you do not use to Hidden. “Restore default layout” brings back the factory layout.
4. **Your own profiles**: up to 12 profiles for any program, from templates or from scratch.
5. Click **Save to DIAL FT**.

Custom profile

- Name, icon and color (shown in the Color theme). A template (“Start from template”) fills the profile with ready shortcuts, e.g. for a browser, DaVinci, Premiere, Photoshop, Lightroom, Figma or VS Code.
- Up to 4 modes. Every mode has 4 actions: **turn left**, **turn right**, **tap** and **dial click** (empty click = next mode).
- Every action can be a **macro** - up to 6 steps in a row: keyboard shortcut (click the field and press it), media key, mouse wheel, pause, type text, next / previous mode. Pressing the dial while a macro runs stops it (the screen shows STOPPED).
- Two texts per profile (up to 32 characters, ASCII) for the “Type text” step, e.g. a signature or an e-mail address.
- **Program** (optional): app identifier for auto profile, e.g. com.apple.Safari (macOS) or chrome.exe (Windows).
- **Export / Import profiles**: save all profiles to a file and load them back - a backup or a way to share profiles.

> “Ctrl/Cmd” in shortcuts is sent as Cmd on Mac and Ctrl on Windows - following the Host OS setting. One profile works on both systems.

11. Firmware update

Install updates on the same page (falbatech.click/dial-ft), in the Firmware update section. Settings and custom profiles are kept.

1. Click **1. Prepare** and choose DIAL FT. The screen goes dark - DIAL is in update mode.
2. Click **2. Install update** and choose the port “USB JTAG/serial debug unit”.
3. When it reports success, unplug and plug in DIAL FT.

If DIAL does not enter update mode: unplug the cable, hold the BOOT button on the back of the board, plug the cable in, release the button and start from step 2.

Updating to DFTv1.5: settings, custom profiles and the desktop layout are kept. The new Timer and Stopwatch apps are added to your desktops automatically.

12. DIAL FT Helper (optional)

A small background program. Download it from the configurator. It adds:

- Spotify cover art, title, artist and progress on the DIAL screen,
- automatic profile switching when you change apps (DaVinci, Premiere, Final Cut, Photoshop, Lightroom, Pixelmator, Spotify, Zoom, Teams, Figma, Blender, Fusion 360, KiCad and your profiles); in browsers and reading apps (Safari, Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Word, Excel, PDF, Slack, Notion, VS Code and more) DIAL switches to Smart Scroll (vertical) by itself,
- the time for the clock face and Pomodoro statistics,
- a sound and notification on the computer when Pomodoro or the Timer ends,
- the Claude Code and Codex status on DIAL (working / needs you / done).

Enable Claude Code notifications later (if you said “no” during installation): macOS - `python3 ~/Library/Application\ Support/FalbaTech/DIAL\ FT/dialft_helper.py --install-claude-hooks`; Linux - `python3 ~/.local/share/falbatech/dial-ft/dialft_helper.py --install-claude-hooks`; Windows - `powershell -File "%LOCALAPPDATA%\FalbaTech\DIAL FT\dialft_helper.ps1" -InstallClaudeHooks`. For Codex: --install-codex-hooks / -InstallCodexHooks, then /hooks in Codex. To turn off: --remove-claude-hooks, --remove-codex-hooks (Windows -RemoveClaudeHooks, -RemoveCodexHooks). Your other Claude Code settings are kept; a copy is saved as settings.json.dialft-backup.

Versions: **macOS**, **Windows 10/11** (nothing to install, built-in PowerShell) and **Linux** (Python 3; auto profile in X11 sessions). Download them from the configurator.

Windows: unzip and double-click `install_windows.cmd` (if SmartScreen warns: “More info” → “Run anyway”). **Linux:** run `install_linux.sh`; your user must be in the dialout group (Arch: uucp).

macOS: unzip the archive and run `install_mac.sh` in Terminal. The helper starts automatically at login. On the first song macOS asks for permission to control Spotify - click Allow. Uninstall: `install_mac.sh --uninstall`.

Auto profile does not switch while you are in Settings or Pomodoro. Turn it off in Settings → Auto profile.

13. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Shortcuts do not work on Mac (or Windows)	Set Settings → Host OS to match your computer.
Scrolling goes the wrong way	Settings → Scroll dir or a tap in the Smart Scroll profile.
No clock when idle	Connect the configurator or install DIAL FT Helper (DIAL has no battery clock).
COLOR moves something else	Keep the pointer over a value in Resolve, not over a node or clip.
No Spotify cover art	Run DIAL FT Helper and allow it to control Spotify (System Settings → Privacy → Automation).
The configurator cannot see DIAL	Use Chrome or Edge, close other programs using the DIAL port, reconnect the cable.
DIAL does not respond	Unplug and plug in the USB cable. Settings are not lost.

14. Specifications and safety

Display	round 1.28″, 240×240, touch
Input	dial with click, touchscreen
Lighting	ring of 5 RGB LEDs
Processor	ESP32-S3
Connector	USB-C, power and data
Systems	macOS, Windows, Linux
Housing	wooden base, metal ring
Firmware	DFTv1.5

- Indoor use only; keep away from water and moisture.
- Clean the wood with a dry or slightly damp cloth and the screen with a soft cloth, no chemicals.
- Do not open the housing or bend the cable at the plug.
- Do not dispose of the device with household waste - take it to an electronics collection point.